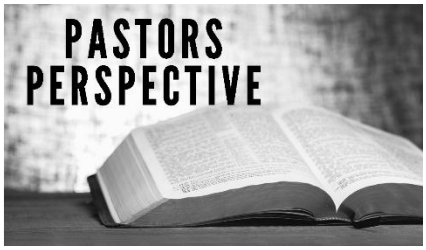
September 2026 Volume 30, Issue 9

THE ROCKY HOCK ANCHOR

The Mission of Rocky Hock Baptist Church is to magnify Christ and make disciples of all people.



"It Just Ain't What It Used To Be"

Good Things Can Go Downhill Real Quick, If You're Not Careful!

Psalm 85:6 – *"Wilt thou not revive us again: that thy people may rejoice in thee?"*

Growing up in a Christian household, my family was known to frequent a large, locally owned Christian bookstore in the mountains. People came from near and far *just* to visit this bookstore. They had a little bit of everything – entire walls filled with Bibles and study materials and devotions! You could even grab a "track" (CD or cassette) off the shelf and take it to one of their cubicles to sing along with it and find your key! In the back, they had an additional room where you could purchase sound equipment and keyboards. It was awesome! Sadly, however, over the last 10 years or so, this store has gone "downhill." Entire shelves and portions of the store are now empty. *And the last time I visited this location, I couldn't help but say… "this place just ain't what it used to be."*

Continuing on with this same line of thought, my mind is also drawn to a restaurant that was located near the church where I grew up! This particular grill was owned by a hard-working lady who cooked food that tasted like heaven. They had a big salad bar and a seafood buffet… and once again, people came from near and far to indulge. As soon as church was over on Sunday morning, it was almost as if people ran to their cars and went straight there because the food was so good and fresh. You went in and you felt like family. Unfortunately, when the recession hit, they had to start buying cheaper stuff (that didn't taste as good) from their food provider. While this restaurant managed to stay open for a few more years… the food got worse and worse. Eventually, they ended up closing the doors. *Still to this day, every time I drive past that building, I can't help but say… "that place just ain't what it used to be."*

Lastly, about a mile from where I grew up, there used to be a little gas station/general store. This was the kind of place where people could sit around all day and drink coffee or grab a gallon of milk on the way home from work without having to go all the way back into town. *They had everything!* Chewing gum, ice cream, random antiques hanging on the walls, and just about any staple you might need to prepare for "snow-mageddon." It was known for being a place of *camaraderie* and *convenience*. I never thought that I'd see this place shut down… because it was so well-loved. But one day, the owners decided to sell and it sat vacant for about 10 years before being converted into something else. *Every time I drive past that place, it's hard not to say, "that place just ain't what it used to be!"*

I bet you have stories like this, too. I think we can all look back over the course of our lives and remember those special stores and restaurants that were so popular and seemed invincible. Stores and shops that eventually "peaked" and then started to go "downhill." *Maybe they don't even exist anymore.*

As I considered these things, I asked myself a serious question. Is it possible for this to happen to a church? For example, do you remember churches that were once "on fire" for the Lord? Churches that were full every Sunday? Churches that used to make a major impact on their communities… but now *"they just ain't what they used to be?"*

For my part, I can look back to some churches that used to be "popular" when I was a little boy… and now they no longer exist. They were on fire for the Lord and souls were being saved, but then something happened… and now *"they just ain't what they used to be."* This can happen to the best of churches, if they lose their focus on Jesus.

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What about you? Could someone look at your life and say the same thing? That you're not what you used to be (in a bad way)? That you *used* to be "on fire" for the Lord and active in your church? That you *used* to participate and serve and attend Sunday School and Worship and Sunday / Wednesday Evening Services? That you *used* to share the Gospel and read your Bible every day? That you used to pray? Perhaps this is you. *If we've learned anything from the stories I mentioned above… it's that spiritual stagnation and decline can happen to anybody who's not keeping their focus on the main thing*.

With that being said, as we move forward into the month of September and prepare our hearts for Fall Revival (Oct. 4-7), I challenge you to examine your hearts to see if you are still on fire for Jesus or if you're going "downhill" in your devotion to the Lord.

Pastor Trey Rogers, Senior Pastor

A Message from Our Revival Speaker



Hello, blessed family-in-Christ. Praises to our Lord and Savior, Jesus Christ! Thanks be to the Heavenly Father and His Love for us, and for allowing us to receive His Holy Spirit! My wife Carla and I are thrilled to be with you for your Fall Revival this year. We come to you as servants of the Living God. We have ministered to churches in the mountain area for over thirty years now. God has blessed us along our journey with three children, seven grandchildren, and one to come to us in January. His blessings are immediate and eternal!

I feel that the Lord has used me and my wife in many roles to minister to many people of all ages, both at church and in the workplace. We have tried to serve and learn from Him for our entire marriage (44 years). He has taught us, instructed us, humbled, grown us, and showed us that we must together build our faith and trust in Him.

I currently pastor Meadow Grove Baptist Church in Hayesville, NC, accumulating nearly nineteen years with this beloved body. I pastored Downings Creek Baptist Church for nine years and have served on staff at Truett Memorial First Baptist Church – all locally. My 'heart' burns to share the gospel, preach the gospel, and teach the gospel. I avidly enjoy hunting and fishing, high school and college sports, but really love two things the most: spending time with My Lord and spending time traveling with and listening to my wife – all with smiles, of course!

We are blessed and excited to be with you in October. I am praying for the Holy Spirit's freedom on each of you; freedom to move you, empower you, and to renew you in spirit and mind. The Heavenly Father will supply us and reveal to us His Will if we ask, seek, and knock.

Rev. Keith Nuckolls

BAPTIST MEN



The Baptist Men's Breakfast will be on Sunday, September 20th at 7:30 AM in the Special Function Room. Gentlemen, please join us for food, fellowship, and devotion!



UNEXPECTED MERCY

From: devotions4teens.com

Background Story: Jonah was a prophet of Israel who God had called to share His words with the people.

Read: Jonah 1

The word of the Lord came to Jonah son of Amittai: [2] "Go to the great city of Nineveh and preach against it, because its wickedness has come up before me." [3] But Jonah ran away from the Lord and headed for Tarshish. He went down to Joppa, where he found a ship bound for that port. After paying the fare, he went aboard and sailed for Tarshish to flee from the Lord. [4] Then the Lord sent a great wind on the sea, and such a violent storm arose that the ship threatened to break up. [5] All the sailors were afraid and each cried out to his own god. And they threw the cargo into the sea to lighten the ship. But Jonah had gone below deck, where he lay down and fell into a deep sleep. [6] The captain went to him and said, "How can you sleep? Get up and call on your god! Maybe he will take notice of us so that we will not perish." [7] Then the sailors said to each other, "Come, let us cast lots to find out who is responsible for this calamity." They cast lots and the lot fell on Jonah. [8] So they asked him, "Tell us, who is responsible for making all this trouble for us? What kind of work do you do? Where do you come from? What is your country? From what people are you?" [9] He answered, "I am a Hebrew and I worship the Lord, the God of heaven, who made the sea and the dry land." [10] This terrified them and they asked, "What have you done?" (They knew he was running away from the Lord, because he had already told them so.)
[11] The sea was getting rougher and rougher. So they asked him, "What should we do to you to make the sea calm down for us?"
[12] "Pick me up and throw me into the sea," he replied, "and it will become calm. I know that it is my fault that this great storm has come upon you." [13] Instead, the men did their best to row back to land. But they could not, for the sea grew even wilder than before. [14] Then they cried out to the Lord, "Please, Lord, do not let us die for taking this man's life. Do not hold us accountable for killing an innocent man, for you, Lord, have done as you pleased." [15] Then they took Jonah and threw him overboard, and the raging sea grew calm. [16] At this the men greatly feared the Lord, and they offered a sacrifice to the Lord and made vows to him. [17] Now the Lord provided a huge fish to swallow Jonah, and Jonah was in the belly of the fish three days and three nights.

Big Idea: Storms and smelly fish may be God's mercy in your life!

It seems almost ridiculous that Jonah, a prophet of God, thinks he can run away from God by getting on a boat and sailing away. As a prophet to the people and to the Kings of Israel (2 Kings 14:21-25), Jonah knows that God sees all, knows all, and carries out His plan. But nevertheless, here we see Jonah on a boat trying to find a place outside of God's reach. What's God's response to Jonah's pride and disobedience?

In verse 17, it says, "Now the Lord provided a huge fish to swallow Jonah." Provided? In God's mercy, He provided a space for Jonah to turn back towards obedience. Punishment would have meant drowning, but this giant fish was God's unexpected mercy.

In Jonah's life and in ours, God may send circumstances or close doors to steer us back on course or to protect us from unseen situations. Maybe you get a rejection letter from your 1st choice college, a relationship ends, or you don't get the job you wanted. Maybe you get caught by your parents before you make a terrible decision. In all those situations, they feel bad and frustrating at the moment. But God is sovereign (all knowing), and good, and loves us more than we can understand. He has a plan for your life and will do what is necessary to protect you and keep you in right relationship with Him (including a smelly fish and a big storm).

If you find yourself running from God's will and plan, instead of having to spend time in your fish, learn from Jonah and turn. Turn to God, daily surrendering your life, your will, and your ways to Him. Maturity in our Christian walk means we begin to trust Him, knowing that if He removes something, closes a door, or says no, it's for YOUR GOOD. Today, thank Him for His sovereignty, mercy, and goodness!

Takeaway Verses: Psalm 37: 5
"Commit your way to the Lord; trust in him, and he will act."

Song For Today: "Hills and Valleys" by Tauren Wells

Baptist Women

Meant for the Mission

What Is God's Mission?

GOD RESTORES US TO A RIGHT RELATIONSHIP WITH HIMSELF.

Does your church have a mission statement? Many churches have them to describe God's purpose for the church. WMU's mission statement is "to make disciples of Jesus who live on mission." And every two years, we home in on a special emphasis to help us achieve that mission. The WMU Emphasis for 2026-2028 is "Meant for the Mission." We are reminded that God has appointed believers to carry out His mission. But what is God's mission?

SIN SEPARATES US FROM GOD

In the beginning, Adam and Eve had a right relationship with God. God talked to and walked with them in the Garden. However, Adam and Eve failed to obey. Instead, they chose to rebel against their Creator. So God rightly punished them and cast them out of the Garden, away from His presence. Adam and Eve no longer had a right relationship with God. Their sin separated them from Him.

Adam and Eve's choice had terrible consequences for humankind. All people were now in a fallen condition. Romans 3:23 says, "All have sinned and fall short of the glory of God." Our sin separates us from God, and the price for our sin is death (Romans 6:23). This means the just punishment for our sin is physical and spiritual death. We are unable to save ourselves from the consequences of our sin. We need a Savior and Redeemer.

JESUS RECONCILES US TO GOD

The Bible says God loved the world so much He sent His only Son, Jesus, to save us from our sin and restore us to a right relationship with Himself. Jesus lived a sinless life as a man on earth and died on the Cross. His blood paid the price for our sins. Jesus was buried in a tomb, but God raised Him from the dead. When Jesus conquered death, God's mission was accomplished! Through His Son's life, death, and Resurrection, all people can be reconciled to God and have a right relationship with Him. One day, those who put their faith in Him will live with God and enjoy His presence forever!

GOD GIVES US A MISSION

God has appointed the church to play a part in His mission. Believers carry our God's mission by sharing the good news that Jesus came to save people from sin and reconcile us to God. **We are to be disciples who make disciples.** Now that's a powerful mission statement for the church!

from Missions Mosaic, Fall 2026, wmu.com
By Dr. Tracey Gholson, Pastor's wife from Nashville, TN with a Doctor of Ministry Degree from Beeson Divinity School. She serves on the Executive Board of Tennessee WMU.

CBA Church Leadership Training Conference

Sunday, October 4th @ Berea Baptist Church, Elizabeth City
4:00 – 7:30 PM – Snack Supper Provided

Conference Offerings include: Church Revitalization, Pastor's Conference: "How to Stay," Long Term Strategy for Your Church, Evangelistic Outreach, Next Gens Ministry, Managing Church Finances, Preschool Ministry, Deacon Training, Becoming a Master Teacher, Women's Missionary Union, Discipleship for the Small Church, Small Church Worship & Technology, Missions Engagement, and Children's Ministry. For more information, call Dr. Jeff Russell at 252-340-3272.

Deacon Team of the Week

8/30/26 – 9/5/26
Russell Byrum, Matthew Evans, Phil Smith

9/6/26 – 9/12/26
Adam Bunch, Ted Peele, Oscar White

9/13/26 – 9/19/26
Steve Evans, Roger Smith, Chris Turner

9/20/26 – 9/26/26
Donald Bass, Allen Peele, Sam Tynch

9/27/26 – 10/3/26
Carroll Evans, Ruston Howell, Danny Lewis

September Deacon Greeters

Senior Adult Building: Oscar White

Sanctuary Main Entrance: Ruston Howell

Connecting Corridor: Scott Noble

Multi-Purpose Main Entrance: Phil Smith

September Ushers

Neal Bass, Tony Bass, Matthew Evans,
Leon Hemmings, Stanley Tynch, Bob Wallace

September Offering Team

Adam Bunch(Lead), Wayne Bunch,
Carroll Evans, Phil Smith,
Paul Ward, Oscar White

September Counting Committee

Mike Evans, Frank & Hope Gosser,
Billy & LouAnn Elliott



Sunday Attendance:	SS	AM	PM
7/26/26:	143	267	80
8/2/26:	155	252	85
8/9/26:	120	178	70
8/16/26:	146	244	90

Wednesday PM Attendance:	
7/29/26:	57
8/5/26:	57
8/12/26:	61
8/19/26:	64

Edenton-Chowan Food Pantry

The request from RHBC this month is:

RICE (1 lb. bag)



CHILDREN'S PAGE for children of all ages

Bible Drill

Training for Children and Youth Bible Drill 2027 will begin Sunday, September 13th at 5:00. Pizza will be provided for our Bible Drillers at this first meeting and their material will also be provided. Children's Drill is for Grades 4-6; however, 3rd Graders can participate at the Church Drill level. Youth Drill is for Grades 7-9. Please encourage your children and youth to participate. Contact Donna Peele or Alanna Bass with any questions on Children's Drills and Cindy Ricks or Kimberly McPherson for Youth Drills.

Bible DRILL





Church Conference will be on Wednesday, September 30th at 7 PM in the Sanctuary, followed by Prayer Meeting, if time permits. All Committees / Ministry Teams should submit a written report (via email to lbunch@rhbce.org or by dropping it off at the Church Office) no later than 12:00 Noon on the date of Conference.

Youth and Children will follow the regular Wednesday night schedule:

6:45 PM – Vertical Student Ministry (6th - 12th Graders) in the Youth Suite (meal provided), GA's (Girls in 1st - 5th Grades) & RA's (Boys in 1st - 5th Grades) – Special Function Room (meal provided)

7 PM - Mission Friends (3 - 5 year olds) - 2 year olds Classroom

FRIENDS & FAMILY DAY

SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 20 @ 11:00 AM

Join us for a time of intentional regathering following the summer, and worship as the family of God.

Everyone is encouraged to invite as many friends and family members as they can and "pack-a-pew!"

Let's fill up HIS house!



ROCKY HOCK BAPTIST CHURCH

113 Rocky Hock Church Road
Edenton, NC 27932

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Check us out on the web at www.rhbce.org

Sundays:
9:45 AM - Sunday School for all ages
11:00 AM - Morning Worship (Nursery & Children's Church available for 3 year olds - 5th Grade); Worship Online at www.rhbce.org, our Facebook page, vimeo, and YouTube
6:00 PM - Evening Worship - ***"DEEP DIVE"*** - Adults in Sanctuary, Youth in Youth Suite, Children in Gym

Wednesdays:
6:45 PM - Vertical Student Ministries (VSM) - Middle & High School Youth - Youth Suite; Girls in Action (1st-5th Grade Girls) - GA's Room, beside foyer; Royal Ambassadors (1st-5th Grade Boys) – RA's Room, upstairs (meal provided for GA's & RA's in Special Function Room during the school year)
7:00 PM - "**WORSHIP** *Seeds*" for Adults - Sanctuary; Mission Friends (3-5 year olds) - 2 year olds Room

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Mary Jo Bass, Treasurer
Trey Bass, Security
Donna Peele, Pianist

Rocky Hock
BAPTIST CHURCH–EDENTON